

EXCEL STACKED BAR CHART

Show composition across categories with long names

07

WHEN TO USE

- Data has **long category names** split into **components**.
- Answers: **How is each group made up?**
- Use it for **headcount**, **survey results** or any breakdown by group.

BUSINESS QUESTION

- How many employees does each department have?
- What is the gender split in each department?
- Which department is the largest?

DATA EXAMPLE

	A	B	C
1	Department	Male	Female
2	Information Technology	58	32
3	Customer Support	30	45
4	Finance	20	22
5	Human Resources	12	28

DATA ANALYST USE CASE

Example: **Workforce Analysis**

QUESTION

How is each department composed?

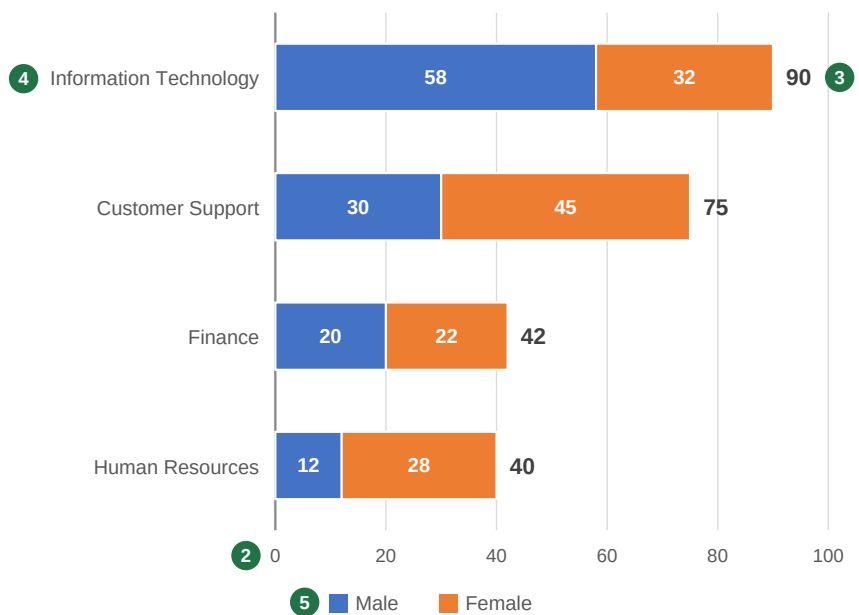
CHART

Stacked Bar Chart

INSIGHT

IT is the largest department (90 staff, 64% male); HR is mostly female (70%).

1 Employee Count by Department & Gender



1 Chart Title 2 Value Axis 3 Bar Total 4 Categories 5 Legend

HOW TO CREATE IT IN EXCEL



- Select** all the data, including the headers (A1:C5).
- Go to the **Insert** tab and open the **Charts** group.
- Click **Insert Column or Bar Chart** > **2-D Bar** > **Stacked Bar**.
- Add a **Chart Title**, then reverse the category order so the first department is on top.
- Format**: add Data Labels inside the bars and keep the legend at the bottom.

DO / DON'T

DO ✓

- ✓ Use bars for long category names
- ✓ Keep to 2-4 segments
- ✓ Add data labels inside the bars
- ✓ Show the total at the bar end

DON'T ✗

- ✗ Use too many segments
- ✗ Compare non-baseline segments exactly
- ✗ Leave the bars unsorted
- ✗ Use it for a single series

DATA ANALYST TIP



Use stacked bars for composition across categories with long names.

If you need to compare segments exactly, use a clustered bar chart instead.